



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

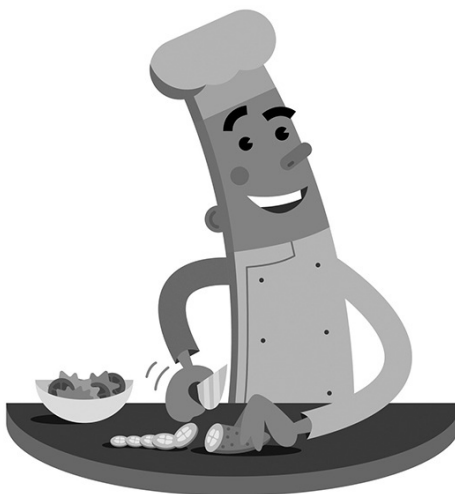
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Let's Start!

It's a reality in my line of work!



Learning Outcome

Describe characteristics of different people and their jobs in common social situations.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can ask and give permission.
- I can show flexibility.

Ask your partner:

- What is your line (area) of work?
- What is the busiest time of year?
Why?
- Is there a slow time of the year?
When?





Let's Explore!

Vanessa is talking to the head chef, Daniel. Will she get the day off?



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Vanessa: Hi Daniel!

Daniel: Hi, Vanessa.

Vanessa: I have a friend from Cambridge staying with me right now. Could I take a few days off next week?

Daniel: Perhaps, but the workload is pretty heavy during the Christmas season, you know. It's a reality in our line of work.

Vanessa: Yes, I know that. Do you mind if someone takes my shifts next week? I could do extended hours when I get back.

Daniel: It's a possibility, but I don't want to be short of staff. We have to maintain quality service at this time of year.

Vanessa: I understand. Do you mind if I ask Nancy?

Daniel: I don't mind. Nancy might agree. I know she wants to have time off after New Years. You could ask her to trade shifts.

Vanessa: Ok, thank you, Daniel.

Daniel: Good luck!





Let's Practice!

Vanessa needs to ask for permission. How does she do it?

Instructions: Draw a line from the first part of the statement on the left to the second part on the right.

- | | |
|---------------------------|---------------------------|
| 1. Could I take | if I trade shifts? |
| 2. Can I ask | a few days off next week? |
| 3. Would it be all right | I leave early today? |
| 4. Do you mind if someone | but please ask Nancy. |
| 5. Is it OK if | works my shift next week? |
| 6. Perhaps, | you something? |



Let's Practice!

Vanessa asked for time off. What is the response from the head chef?

Instructions: Use the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

Perhaps
short of staff
shifts

service
workload

line of work
heavy

The _____ is very _____ during this time of year. It's a reality in our _____. I don't want to be _____. We have to maintain quality _____ at this time of year. You could ask Nancy to trade _____.





Extension Activity

Discuss what it's like to work in different fields.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, choose 3 different lines of work to discuss. Choose general areas of work, like healthcare or travel, not specific jobs.
- Complete the table.
- Discuss those lines of work.
- Which line of work do you find interesting? Explain why.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I choose 3 lines of work to discuss.

☐ ☐

I complete the table about work.

☐ ☐

I discuss different lines of work with my partner.

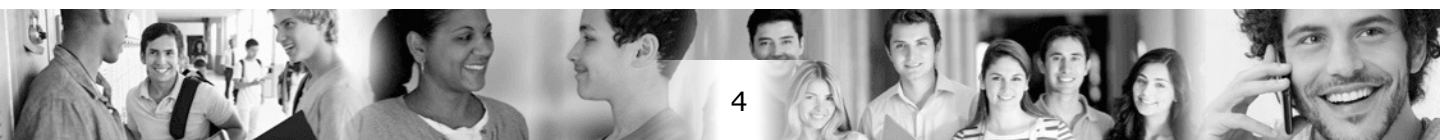
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Line of work:			
When it is very busy			
When it is not busy			
Good things			
Bad things			



Target Words

- workload** (noun): the amount of work a person or group of people must complete
e.g. The workload is pretty heavy during the Christmas season.
- line of work** (expression): industry; field; area of business
e.g. It's a reality in our line of work.
- shift** (noun): the time a person is scheduled to work in one day
e.g. Could somebody take some of my shifts next week?
- extended hours** (expression): longer periods of work than what is normally the case
e.g. I could do extended hours when I get back.
- possibility** (noun): chance
e.g. What you are suggesting is a possibility.
- short of staff** (expression): not having enough employees to do the work
e.g. I don't want to be short of staff.





Learning Points

Asking and Giving Permission

When you ask for permission, it is important to be polite.

You often use a modal like *can*, *may*, *could* or *would* to ask for permission.

You can also ask a Yes or No question like "*Is it OK if ...* " or "*Do you mind ...* "

Here are some ways to ask for and give permission.

Asking for Permission	Giving Permission
<i>Could I take a few days off next week?</i> <i>Can I ask you something?</i> <i>Would it be all right if I change projects?</i> <i>Do you mind if someone takes my shifts next week?</i> <i>Is it OK if I leave early today?</i>	<i>Sure.</i> <i>Perhaps.</i> <i>Of course.</i> <i>No problem.</i> <i>I don't mind.</i>

Showing Flexibility (Possibility)

You can express possibility using a modal like *might* or *may*. You can also use some words and expressions like *it's a possibility* or *there's a chance*.

Examples:

- *Nancy might agree.*
- *Frank may want to work on that project.*
- *Perhaps John will work with us.*
- *Maybe Heather is interested in changing shifts.*

